Berlin University Alliance

Berlin Leadership Academy

ZEWK
Zentraleinrichtung Wissenschaftliche Weiterbildung und Kooperation

The Leadership Certificate for (junior) professors and junior research group leaders

The Leadership Certificate for (junior) professors and junior research group leaders of the Berlin Leadership Academy of the Berlin University Alliance is a two-stage, curricular continuing education programme. The certificate programme is run by the Central Institution for Continuing Education and Cooperation (ZEWK) at Technische Universität Berlin.

The programme offers participants the opportunity to reflect on and further develop their leadership skills. They gain insights into the specific requirements and challenges of leadership in the academic and higher education system and take an in-depth look at their role as leaders.

Through the basic modules, participants come to understand both the limitations and the potential of their actions as leaders. They acquire practical tools for the effective and structured organization of collaboration and are empowered to actively and deliberately shape their leadership role. They acquire competencies in the application of leadership tools and develop the ability to communicate across hierarchical levels within the university and the wider academic community in a respectful and constructive manner.

Throughout the programme, participants enhance their communication skills and learn how to work with their teams using strength-based approaches. They are supported in embracing and successfully fulfilling their leadership responsibilities.
The basic certificate imparts essential knowledge on managing personnel in academic settings. The full certificate enables participants to deepen and broaden this knowledge according to their personal interests and professional needs.

Modules of the basic Leadership Certificate:

- Kick-off workshop
- Leadership in the special context university (basic module I)
- Leading teams in academia (basic module II)
- Management tools for academic leaders (basic module III)
- Final workshop

The full certificate is awarded upon successful completion of the basic certificate, the final workshop and at least two one-day events from different areas of specialization. The programme also includes optional collegial case consultation, reflection and self-study phases as well as individual coaching sessions. The time required to obtain the basic certificate is 40 work units (each 45 minutes) and for the overall certificate 100 work units (each 45 minutes).

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Dr. Matthias König

has successfully completed the Leadership Certificate (overall certificate) for Junior Professors and Junior Research Group Leaders.

Dr. Matthias König participated in the following courses with a total of 100 work units (each 45 minutes):

- Kick-off workshop "... and suddenly I am a leader"
- Leadership in the special context university (basic module I)
- Leading teams in academia (basic module II)
- Management tools for academic leaders (basic module III)
- LEGO®SERIOUS®PLAY® method – visualizing and constructively addressing problems encountered in everyday management (advanced course)
- Introduction to Positive Leadership (advanced course)
- More impact in the auditorium - How to increase your persuasiveness with professional Presence (advanced course)
- Self-management and motivation in times of change (advanced course)
- It's all in the voice! – Confident presentation through body language and Voice (advanced course)
- Final workshop "You've come a long way..."

Berlin, 21st of July 2025

Prof. Dr. Annette Mayer
Head of the Central Institution for Scientific Continuing Education and Cooperation

Dr. Christina Ayazi
Central institution Scientific Continuing education and cooperation
Programme coordinator BLA

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